some humble way, mimics the creation of a real human being. Here from stems theistic quandary of 'Intelligent Design' - must any intelligent, capable being necessarily be the product of design by another, more intelligent, more capable being?

The 'ingredients' of a robot, so to speak, are thus in some sense minimalistic. Factors of safety, precise constraints of space, and the minimum redundancy to balance safety and practicality are the hallmarks of the design process. Even so, robots are actually made of something - and just as the study of human biology can be fascinating enough to lead to entire subfields like medicine, anthropology, cell biology and so on, the study of individual components and subsystems of a robot has matured into a diverse and complex field. The kinds of functionality provided in terms of locomotion, structuring, interactivity, automation, actuation and sensing have all sprung into blossoming branches of research and development. Read on to learn about the immense thought and decades of pioneering that have shaped different subsections of robotic development.

How it looks - the body

The body of a robot is arguably its most defining characteristic. There are anthropomorphic robots that are designed to look like humans and mimic human abilities, but these are often at the frontiers of research and develop-

Source: Wikimedia

The anthropomorphic robot TOPIO, that is designed to play excellent table-tennis.